



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Lesotho: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-23

Edition of 2026-08-23 · 68 systems and instruments tracked, 2 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-23 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 68 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 32 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-23, 15 did not, 19 carry no stated baseline, and 2 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 59 sources for this place in the window — 12 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 47 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

The twelve months to 10 August 2026 added instruments and institutions and left the operating systems where they were. Three policies were signed, an interim response team and a cybersecurity forum were created, a data-centre project was approved, and a wallet-based investment product opened. The national switch, the mobile money platforms, the identity system and the social registry's management information system all end the period in the position they began it in.

The instruments that arrived are mostly unreadable from here. The [three policies signed on 12 June 2026](#) are held as reported signings and not as texts; the [bilateral health agreement with the United States](#) was signed in December 2025 and its related data-sharing instrument has not been published; the National Cybersecurity Strategy invoked at the [CSIRT launch](#) is not held. What can be compared over this period is therefore mostly the existence of things rather than their content.

The one position that did not move and would have been expected to is data protection: the Act has been in force since 2011 and its [Commission was still unappointed in March 2026](#).

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network (LEMOFI) | Did not exist                                                            | Feasibility study completed, laying groundwork for expanding high-speed broadband connectivity across major towns; construction not reported | ADVANCED  |
| Starlink satellite internet service                      | Live through T-Connect, the sole reseller                                | Live through T-Connect, and reported also carried over Vodacom low-earth-orbit backhaul (2026-01)                                            | ADVANCED  |
| Vodacom Lesotho mobile network                           | A network upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit (2025-08) | 1.21m customers and 85% market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and 2G 97%, 3G 98% and 4G 96% coverage (2026-06)             | ADVANCED  |
| Econet Telecom Lesotho 5G network                        | 149 5G sites on 700MHz (2025-06)                                         | 149 5G sites on 700MHz; no later figure held                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE |
| Econet Wi-Fi Plus fixed-mobile convergence service       | In service                                                               | In service; nothing later on record                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE |
| Starlink operating licence                               | Granted, and contested over 100% foreign ownership                       | Granted; nothing later on record resolves the local-shareholding objection                                                                   | NO CHANGE |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Project Kobong hydropower and AI data centre | Did not exist | Approved, on a binding Memorandum of Agreement of 4 June 2026 covering at least 1,200MW of pumped storage and a green-powered AI data centre at Mokhotlong, conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements, with construction targeted for 2029                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |
| National data-centre implementation roadmap  | Not held      | In drafting at a five-day, six-ministry workshop that opened in Maseru on 17 August 2026 and runs to 21 August, organised by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho and coordinated by the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies, alongside a National AI Strategy drafted in the same room; it covers data governance, skills, compute, energy, cooling, financing and implementation choices, and builds on the artificial-intelligence, data-management and broadband policies the government validated in draft in January 2025 | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Electricity generation against domestic demand | BASELINE NOT HELD | About 72MW installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, with 438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 imported | Baseline not held |

## Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Mohale's Hoek government data centre | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Tier III facility under the e-Government Infrastructure Project, near-complete pending its power station, designed as 100km-separated backup to the Finance Ministry's Maseru data centre; no later source confirms completion or operational status | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01                                                          | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                | MOVEMENT        |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Government Chief Information Security Officer | Did not exist                                                          | Appointed, reported as the first such post across government                                                 | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| Interim national CSIRT (LesComCSIRT)          | Did not exist                                                          | Operating on an interim basis, ahead of the statute intended to establish it                                 | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| National Cybersecurity Forum                  | Did not exist                                                          | Standing, spanning government, industry, regulators, financial institutions and telecommunications providers | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| National Security Operations Centre           | Budgeted for establishment, per the 2025/26 budget speech (2025-02-19) | Reported being stood up; no host, operator or date published                                                 | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

The cybersecurity estate went from nothing on record to four named institutions inside two days of July 2026. The [interim CSIRT and the National Cybersecurity Forum](#) were launched on 29 July, a Chief Information Security Officer was appointed across government, and a Security Operations Centre was reported being stood up. The two bills that would put the response team on a statutory footing [await National Assembly approval](#), so the institutional position at the end of the period is ahead of the legal one.

The data-centre position moved from nothing to an [approved project](#) on 31 July 2026, on an agreement signed on 4 June that is conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements, with construction targeted for 2029. Nothing else is on the record: no government hosting arrangement and no capacity figure for any national facility.

The networks moved less than the announcements suggest. Vodacom Lesotho's published position went from a pledged upgrade in August 2025 to [1.21m customers and 85% market share in June 2026](#), with 422 base stations of which 101 are solar; Econet's last published network figure remains [149 5G sites on 700MHz from June 2025](#). Starlink was already retailing when the period opened and the [objection to its full foreign ownership](#) is where it was.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework | Did not exist | In development; aimed at improving government efficiency and digital service delivery and avoiding fragmented, costly ICT infrastructure deployment across government; no further detail published | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-23                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>X-Road government interoperability platform</b> | Once-only information exchange named as a priority in the India memorandum, with no platform on record (2025-07) | Presented as one of three systems under development; no go-live date published | ADVANCED |

## Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>MOSIP-based integrated national digital ID</b>      | Digital ID pilots begun under the India memorandum, with no platform named (2025-07)     | A 2026 work plan signed with UNICEF to build a MOSIP-based national ID ecosystem covering passport and ID renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification                                           | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Digital birth registration under Ntlafatsa Bana</b> | In operation, with 20,000 Child Grants Programme beneficiaries on digital grant payments | In operation; no later enrolment figure is held                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>National Identification System</b>                  | In operation; the most recent account held is the 2022 World Bank case study             | In operation; no later coverage, enrolment or performance figure is held                                                                                                                                           | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Digital service-ID pilot</b>                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                 | Testing-phase pilot of about 10,000 participants; registration requires a valid national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration; no vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria stated | Baseline not held |

## Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                  | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>M-Pesa Lesotho (VCL Financial Services)</b>            | Operated inside Vodacom Lesotho                                                                                                | Operating as VCL Financial Services, a separately constituted entity, with 14,000 agents (2026-06)                                                                            | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Renminbi settlement access through CIPS</b>            | Did not exist                                                                                                                  | Available through Standard Bank, one of five markets added beyond South Africa                                                                                                | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Revenue Services Lesotho tax e-payment integration</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                                  | Live for company tax, PAYE, VAT and customs duties over USSD, internet banking and the bank's mobile application                                                              | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Tsetela wallet investment service</b>                  | Did not exist                                                                                                                  | Live over USSD on *200#, from M50 for individual M-Pesa customers and M300 for Mokhatlo group-savings customers, with STANLIB Lesotho licensed by the Central Bank of Lesotho | ADVANCED  |
| <b>EcoCash mobile money</b>                               | In service on the platform migrated in October 2024, with group savings, payroll and fraud detection integrated                | Unchanged; wallet interest payouts were stated as forthcoming and nothing later is held                                                                                       | NO CHANGE |
| <b>LeSwitch national payment switch</b>                   | Instant payments (2022), ATM localisation (2024-10) and point-of-sale localisation (2025-05) live across four commercial banks | Unchanged; e-commerce and retail were named as next and nothing later is held                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01                                                             | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>NISSA social registry</b> | Holding data on more than 90% of households, categorised by vulnerability | Same coverage, with a child-centred redesign piloted in Mafeteng District under the Universal DPI Safeguards Framework | ADVANCED |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                   | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Foundational Literacy and Numeracy Dashboard</b>          | Did not exist                                                   | Under construction for Grades 1-3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces     | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National monitoring and evaluation reporting capacity</b> | Did not exist                                                   | A consultancy advertised to strengthen the national AIDS commission capacity to coordinate national monitoring and evaluation reporting | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>MISSA social-assistance management information system</b> | Procurement issued in 2024, with no award or delivery on record | Procurement issued in 2024, with no award or delivery on record                                                                         | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Decision Support System for planning and budgeting</b>    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                        | Presented as under development; no scope, host or date published                                                                        | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                        | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>E-Parliament system</b>                         | Did not exist                                                                                                        | Implemented, described as marking a key milestone in modernising legislative processes; no further detail published | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>eGovernment Infrastructure Project Phase II</b> | An African Development Bank commitment of US\$13.95m (2019), with US\$16.5m disbursed and the project ending in 2026 | Digital Outreach Studio launched under the project (2026-06)                                                        | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National Data Value Creation Blueprint</b>      | Did not exist                                                                                                        | Drafting opened at a first consultative workshop; no text exists                                                    | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Separate government ICT agency</b>              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                             | Announced; no enabling instrument, scope or date published                                                          | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Rural digital data capture

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>T-Connect Impact school and clinic connectivity</b> | Did not exist | Operating, following the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025 | ADVANCED |

## Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Maseru City Council Construction Permit Automation System | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Live at <a href="http://mcc-cp.org.ls">mcc-cp.org.ls</a> , built by Computer Business Solutions (Lesotho) with Web Masters Kenya under World Bank Private Sector Competitiveness Project funding: online application, document upload, staged review, SMS/email notifications, auto-generated invoices and digital permit issue | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

Payments gained products, not rails. LeSwitch ends the period exactly where it started — instant transfers, ATM and point-of-sale transactions cleared domestically across [four commercial banks](#), with e-commerce and retail still named as next. What changed is what runs on top: Vodacom's mobile money was [reconstituted as VCL Financial Services](#) in March 2026 and now runs 14,000 agents, [Tsetela](#) opened investment from M50 in July 2026, [tax e-payment](#) went live in February 2026, and [renminbi settlement](#) became available in July. EcoCash is unchanged on the platform it migrated to in October 2024.

Identity advanced on paper. The digital-ID position opened the period as pilots under the [India memorandum](#) with no platform named and closes it with a [2026 work plan with UNICEF](#) for a MOSIP-based system; the National Identification System that is actually in operation has no account later than 2022, so no coverage or enrolment figure can be compared at either end.

The interoperability layer moved from a stated priority to two named systems — X-Road and a Decision Support System, both [presented as work in progress in February 2026](#) with no go-live date. Drafting of a [National Data Value Creation Blueprint](#) opened in July 2026 and no text exists. A [learning-data dashboard](#) entered construction, and satellite connectivity for [schools and clinics](#) began in January 2026. The social registry's management information system did not move at all: its [procurement was issued in 2024](#) and no award or delivery is on record.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Cybercrime Bill      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill and awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable                                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Cybersecurity Bill   | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill, intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, and awaiting National Assembly approval | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                        | MOVEMENT        |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy | Not signed    | Signed; no implementation instrument or regulator guidance on record | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| Data Management Policy                  | Not signed    | Signed, framed as a privacy, security and ethical-use framework      | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| National AI Policy                                    | Not signed    | Signed, covering responsible AI in health, education and public administration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED  |
| National AI Strategy                                  | Did not exist | Being drafted at the same five-day Maseru workshop as the data-centre blueprint, organised by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho, and intended as the framework for deploying artificial intelligence; the deputy prime minister's keynote asked for capability assessment, safeguards, infrastructure, policy and human capacity to be settled before investment is scaled | ADVANCED  |
| National Digital Policy 2024                          | In force      | In force, unamended                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE |
| National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030 | In force      | In force, unamended                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                       | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 50-in-5 DPI campaign membership                   | A member                            | A member; no campaign milestone reported for Lesotho since                                       | NO CHANGE |
| African Union Data Policy Framework domestication | Assessment convened; no output held | Assessment convened; no readiness assessment, legislative review or resulting instrument is held | NO CHANGE |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| LCA Quality of Service Rules (Legal Notice 41 of 2023) | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In force under Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023, prescribing minimum quality-of-service standards for voice, data, postal and courier licensees across service accessibility, integrity and retainability, with two published schedules of measurable parameters                                                                                                                                                                 | Baseline not held |
| Telecoms quality-of-service compliance                 | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 75% overall compliance across twelve general parameters for the two mobile network operators in the year to 2025-03-31, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time; Q3 2025/26 drive-testing across three Maseru clusters in November 2025 found mean LTE download speeds of 2.88-2.95 Mbps against a 25 Mb/s target and unsuccessful call ratios of 2.6-6.2% against a 2% ceiling | Baseline not held |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                              | AT 2025-08-01                    | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Bilateral health agreement with the United States and its data-sharing instrument | Did not exist                    | Signed; the State Department briefly published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published | ADVANCED  |
| Data Protection Act 2011                                                          | In force, unamended              | In force, unamended as at 2026-03-23                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE |
| Data Protection Commission                                                        | Provided for in law, unappointed | Provided for in law, unappointed as at 2026-03-23                                                                                                                                      | NO CHANGE |

## Public debate and participation in policymaking

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Public digital services experience survey | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Open to citizens, covering access, usability, trust and skills gaps across online applications, digital payments and health and education platforms, as part of a donor-backed digital readiness assessment | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

Three instruments were made and none can be read. The [broadband infrastructure sharing, data management and AI policies](#) were signed on 12 June 2026, and the texts are not held.

The most consequential governance change of the period is one the record can describe only from outside. Lesotho [signed a bilateral health agreement with the United States in December 2025 stated at US\\$364m](#); a [FOIA complaint of 2 April 2026](#) records that the State Department briefly published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and that the related data-sharing agreements have not been published at all.

Nothing moved on the domestic data-protection framework, and nothing moved on regional alignment: the [AUDA-NEPAD readiness workshop](#) of July 2025 has produced no assessment, legislative review or instrument that is held here, and Lesotho's [50-in-5 membership](#) has no reported milestone since 2024.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                | MOVEMENT        |
|----------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| National AI Academy  | Did not exist | Proposed in a signed memorandum; no timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution is named | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Private-sector cloud and cybersecurity capacity | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | One executive workshop on record, on ransomware, cloud security, data sovereignty and immutable backup | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01                                             | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT        |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| UNDP-Econet memorandum of understanding | A standing partnership signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 | Renewed across three pillars - digital transformation, connectivity and AI; the innovation ecosystem; and MSME digital entrepreneurship - with no amount, term or deliverable stated | <b>ADVANCED</b> |



## US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| US commercial diplomacy in the digital and energy sectors | Not stated    | Stated by the US Embassy at US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated in Lesotho over the previous eighteen months, of which Kobong is the largest | ADVANCED |

## India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                              | AT 2026-08-23                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Lesotho-India digital public infrastructure memorandum | Signed, naming digital ID, a unified payment environment and once-only information exchange as the year's three priorities | Unchanged; no deliverable, workstream or funding under it is on record | NO CHANGE |

Artificial intelligence went from statements to one signed institutional commitment. The [memorandum Econet Telecom Lesotho and UNDP signed on 28 July 2026](#) renews a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 and names a National AI Academy; it states no amount, term or deliverable, and nothing names a timetable, curriculum or host institution for the Academy. That is the first institutional AI commitment on the record, and it is a memorandum rather than a policy.

The external relationships diverged. The [India memorandum](#) of July 2025 has produced no recorded deliverable in the twelve months since. The American relationship produced the largest project on the ledger, and the [US Embassy states](#) it facilitated US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships over eighteen months, which is its own figure.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Broadband coverage against actual internet use  | BASELINE NOT HELD | 100% broadband coverage against about 50% regular internet use, stated by MICSTI at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance (2026-07) | Baseline not held |
| Cross-border remittance channel to South Africa | BASELINE NOT HELD | Migrant workers moving from banks to fintechs such as Mukuru as South African remittance and banking rules tightened (2026-06)        | Baseline not held |

### Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-23                                                                       | MOVEMENT                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| AI Skills Development Programme                           | Did not exist     | Running, reported as Lesotho's first digital-entrepreneurship and AI-tools training | ADVANCED                |
| Vodacom and AWS digital-skills training                   | Did not exist     | Pledged; nothing on record has been delivered in the twelve months since            | ADVANCED, A PLEDGE ONLY |
| Government digital-literacy training in all ten districts | BASELINE NOT HELD | Running across all ten districts; no participant numbers published                  | Baseline not held       |

## Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Government and National University of Lesotho DPI collaboration | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | One joint review on record; no research programme, funding or output published | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

The government's stated measure of the access problem — [100% broadband coverage against about 50% regular internet use](#) — was given in July 2026, and the base carries no comparable figure from the start of the period, so the gap cannot be shown to have narrowed or widened.

Training moved once. The [AI Skills Development Programme](#) with the US Embassy began in June 2026, and [digital-literacy training](#) is reported across all ten districts without participant numbers. The digital-skills training [pledged with AWS in August 2025](#) has nothing recorded against it in the twelve months since.

## Finance

### MoUs and other agreements

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Development-partner support for the data blueprint | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Named as supporters at the first workshop; no programme document, terms of reference or amount is held | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | M381.1 million allocated to the ICT sector for 2025/26, naming a Government Security Operations Centre (GovSOC), a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed LEMOFI fibre feasibility study, 17 operational base tower stations and a 96km Roma-Thaba-Tseka fibre stretch underway | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

No domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation is held at either end of the period: no budget speech, estimates volume or appropriation act naming a MICSTI vote or a digital-transformation budget line is on record for 2024/25 or later.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT            | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | LAST PROBED |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| National Cybersecurity Strategy | The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy. | 2026-08-10  |
| National open data portal       | A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.                                                                                                                                  | 2026-08-10  |

Two of these absences have been searched for and stayed empty across the period rather than newly appearing. The National Cybersecurity Strategy was invoked again at the July 2026 launch and remains without a published location, and the digital service-ID pilot [reported to have begun with 10,000 participants](#) has produced no enrolment or coverage figure.

The others are absences the period did not create and did not close: where government systems are hosted, whether any municipal digital service exists, whether interoperability or quality-of-service standards have been published, whether an open-data portal exists, and what the state appropriates for digital transformation.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-23</b>                                                                                                                                                   |
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